

```
// declaring variables:
int x, y;
int total;
// process:
x = 5;
y = 2;
x = x + 1;
total = x - y;
// print out the result:
cout << total;
// terminate the program:
return 0;
}
```

The output will be:

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There are three ways you can assign a variable:

- Inside a function, i.e. Local variables. (also known as Automatic variables)
- In the definition of a function parameter, i.e. formal parameters.
- Outside all functions, i.e. Global variables.

Local Variable/Automatic Variable

The Local or Automatic variables are those that are usually declared within a function. Local variables lose their significance outside the blocks of functions within which they are declared.

These Local variables gain significance as long as we are in the body of the functions. Similarly, they lose their values once we exit the functions.

Consider the following program: